

FREE LIGHTNING LESSON · 45 MINUTES

How to Tell If Your Career Is Stalling



Three signs your role may have stopped building your skills and future options, even while you are performing well.

A CAPABILITY FORMATION LIGHTNING LESSON

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What this lesson will not do.

This free lesson will not tell you whether to stay or leave, place you into a Career State, or replace the full Position Read. It will help you recognize three signs worth examining in your own work.



What brought you here today?

Choose the closest reason. No explanation needed.

Promotion or larger role

Reorganization or role change

Internal move decision

External opportunity

My role feels static

General uncertainty

Here's What You'll Leave With Today

1 THE DIFFERENCE

How to distinguish strong performance from continuing career growth.

2 YOUR CAREER STALL CHECK

Three signs examined against evidence from your last 90 days.

3 THE NEXT QUESTION

What deserves closer examination before you decide to stay, reshape the role, or leave.

Performance was never the question I should have been asking.

Years into a role I was performing well in, the structure changed and the role was eliminated. I had good reviews. I was trusted with more. None of that changed what happened next.

“My performance had shaped my standing. It had not insulated the role from a change in structure.”

That distinction sent me looking for a way to read a role for what it is building, not only for how well I am doing in it.

A role can reward you long after it stops building you.

A role can value you and still stop building you.

A team can rely on you and still narrow the range of problems you meet.

Performance is a signal. It is not the full reading.

You Are Repeating, Not Stretching

You may be performing at a high level, but the work is no longer asking you to solve meaningfully unfamiliar problems.

THE TEST

What problem have you solved in the last 90 days that you genuinely did not already know how to solve?

QUICK CHECK

In one word, is your recent work stretching, repeating, or unclear?

You Are Indispensable, but Mainly Here

The organization relies on you, but your value may be increasingly tied to its systems, internal language, relationships, processes, or history.

THE TEST

Could someone outside your company explain your value without using your title or internal company language?

QUICK CHECK

Which has grown fastest: internal dependence, external visibility, or both?

Your Responsibility Is Growing Faster Than Your Capability

Your title, scope, and expectations may be increasing while the range of judgment, unfamiliar problems, or transferable capability being formed in you is narrowing.

THE TEST

What capability do you have now that you did not have before your responsibilities increased?

QUICK CHECK

Which has grown faster: responsibility, learning, or visibility?

Five quiet minutes.

Write privately in the Career Stall Check. This is not the full assessment.

1 Which sign is most present for me?

Repeating instead of stretching, indispensable but mainly here, or responsibility growing faster than capability.

2 What is one example from the last 90 days?

Use a lived example, not a plan, promise, title, or feeling.

3 What capability, learning, or future option may not be growing?

Name the specific thing, not a general sense that something is off.

4 What is the next question I need to investigate?

The question you would need to read more carefully before making a bigger career decision.

A recognition exercise is not a result.

If one sign felt familiar, that does not mean you should leave.

If none felt familiar, that does not mean your role is fully compounding.

Recognition tells you what may deserve examination.

Assessment is what turns the observation into a more defensible read.

As routine output becomes easier to reproduce, the distinction between familiar performance and growing judgment becomes more consequential.

Recognition Is the Beginning of the Read

TODAY: RECOGNITION

Repeated work.

Context-bound value.

Responsibility without capability expansion.

THE WORKSHOP: ASSESSMENT + DECISION

The complete 12-statement initial read

Evidence correction and an evidence-backed second read

Provisional placement or boundary reading

One category of move to test

A completed Next-Move Decision

A 30-day evidence process and a 90-day rescore date

The full Capability Position Read measures these patterns more rigorously through Density and Optionality.

Most career advice begins after you decide to leave. This helps you determine whether leaving is even the right question.

Decide Whether to Stay or Leave Your Job

A Live Career Growth Assessment

The Capability Position Read

Two hours live

105-minute guided Capability Position Read

15-minute Q&A and applications

Field Kit included

30-day evidence process, 90-day rescore

15 seats · \$249 public launch price

You will not be told to quit. You will leave with a more defensible reading of your current position and the category of move your evidence supports testing.



REGISTER — [URL PLACEHOLDER]

Not ready for the full read? Subscribe to Capability Formation.

[Substack URL placeholder] · [Substack QR placeholder]

Eleven minutes for questions.

Questions about the ideas are welcome. Personal readings belong in the full workshop.

1 Good Q&A questions

How do I tell the difference between performance and formation? What does portability mean? What kind of evidence counts?

2 Questions to redirect

Should I leave? What state am I in? What should I do about my manager? Can you score my situation?

3 Boundary line

I can help you clarify what the pattern suggests examining. I cannot make the employment decision for you.

What AI Changes About This Reading

An application of the reading, not a technology lesson.

Where AI makes routine output easier to reproduce, your position depends more heavily on judgment, learning velocity, and capability that travels across unfamiliar problems.

Density and Optionality do not become less important.

They become more consequential.

Optional leave-behind slide. Present only if time and audience interest allow; not counted in the 45-minute core.